HITTER EVALUATION · R&D ADVANCE REPORT

Rafael Devers

SF · Bats L · Age 29 · 2,614 pitches seen · 148 G

Hitter evaluation
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 646240

PA	AVG/OBP/SLG	WOBA	XWOBA	WRC+	HR	K%	BB%	BARREL%	HARD-HIT%	AVG / MAX EV	SPD (FG)
633	.258/.340/.525	.367	.342	136	37	25.4%	10.9%	12.5%	51.6%	92.8 / 112.5	1.8

BOTTOM LINE

1. **Platoon split — weaker vs LHP:** .257 wOBA vs LHP, .430 vs RHP (173 pts; xwOBA .275 / .379; 220 / 404 PA) — a matchup lever late in games.
2. **Vulnerable vs FF 93–95.9:** 37% whiff/swing (league 18%), RV/100 +0.3 (league +0.0) (n=420 pitches).
3. **Punishes cutters:** RV/100 +4.5 (league +0.1), .497 xwOBA on contact (n=210) — avoid in the zone.
4. **xwOBA up lately:** .444 over the last 15 games vs .342 for the season.
5. **Plus power (65):** 12.5% barrels/BBE (85th pct), EV90 107.3 mph, max 112.5, ISO .267.

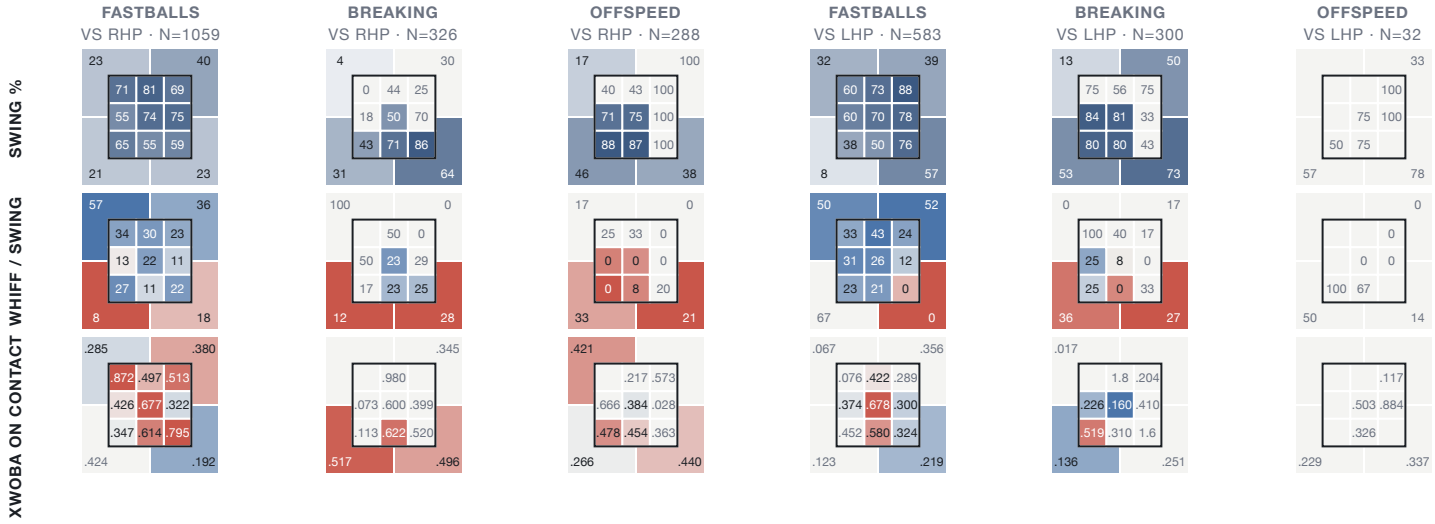
20–80 GRADES

vs 310 hitters ≥1,000 pitches

Hit	45	Contact 73%
Power	65	Barrel 12.5%
Discipline	50	Chase 29%
Pull-air	50	17% of BBE
Speed (Spd)	35	Spd 1.8
vs pitch group	65 FB +1.2	50 BRK +0.3	55 OFF +0.8

ZONES Swing decisions & damage — damage on fastballs heart vs RHP (.677 xwOBAcon); misses fastballs up, middle vs LHP (43% whiff vs 16% league)

Catcher's view, 13 zones (3×3 strike zone + 4 chase quadrants); hitter-relative, so 'in' flips by side. Swing%: darker = swings more (frequency, not quality). Whiff and xwOBA on contact are tinted vs the league rate in the same zone and pitch group (red = better for the hitter). Grey = small sample (<12 pitches, <8 swings, <5 balls in play).



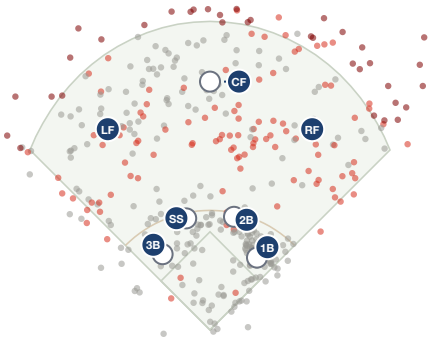
PITCH TYPES Pitch types — best vs cutter (+4.5 RV/100), worst vs sweeper (-0.8)

All pitches seen, both hands. RV/100 = hitter run value per 100 pitches (+ = good for him); Lg = league average for the band. Tints vs league band rates; grey rows n < 80. FF bands overlap (velo and ride).

PITCH / BAND	N	SWING	WHIFF	CHASE	XWOBACON	XWOBA	RV/100	LG
FF 96+ mph	343	49%	37%	25%	.503	.305	+0.9	-0.4
FF 93–95.9	420	45%	37%	26%	.454	.321	+0.3	+0.0
FF < 93	235	40%	28%	19%	.534	.418	+2.4	+0.6
FF ride ≥ 18 in	189	50%	34%	35%	.419	.298	-1.1	-0.8
Sinker	434	47%	12%	26%	.338	.321	+0.1	-0.3
Cutter	210	47%	28%	19%	.497	.426	+4.5	+0.1
Slider	273	54%	29%	38%	.412	.336	-0.3	-0.0
Sweeper	187	51%	33%	44%	.371	.257	-0.8	+0.0
Curveball	166	44%	14%	41%	.407	.389	+2.4	+0.3
Changeup	246	48%	20%	33%	.367	.333	-0.4	+0.1
Splitter	74	51%	21%	43%	.431	.411	+4.7	-0.1

SPRAY Spray — 42% pulled; shift-legal alignment adds -0.5 outs/100 BIP (cross-validated)

All balls in play (grey out, red hit, dark red HR). Hollow = standard alignment, navy = optimized (2 IF each side of 2B, IF on dirt).



BIP MIX	PULL	CENT	OPPO	PULL-AIR	GB	LD	FB	PU
Devers n=401	42%	31%	26%	17%	41%	18%	35%	6%
League	45%	28%	27%	17%	42%	24%	27%	7%

Alignment: -0.5 outs per 100 BIP vs standard, cross-validated (+4.7 in-sample; n=400 BIP batting L). CF 7° toward pull side; 1B 2° toward pull side, 19 ft deeper; 3B 2° toward opposite side, 17 ft deeper.

Rafael Devers

SF · Bats L · 2026 · through **2026-09-27**

ATTACK How to attack — finish with slider down & away vs RHP

Model-preferred pitch (lowest expected xwOBA vs this hitter from a league-average arsenal) and its best location, by count bucket and pitcher hand; second-best and the pitch to avoid with expected xwOBA. Grey line = his actual results on that pitch group in that zone.

COUNT	VS RHP			VS LHP		
Even 0-0, 1-1, 2-2	Slider → Down & away rarely pitched there: 14 breaking all season	.269 2nd CU .276	avoid **SI** .290	Slider → Down & away his breaking there: 25% whiff · .519 xwOBAcon · n=30	.265 2nd ST .268	avoid **FF** .281
Ahead 0-1, 0-2, 1-2	Slider → Down & away rarely pitched there: 14 breaking all season	.292 2nd CU .296	avoid **SI** .307	Four-seam → Down & away his fastballs there: 23% whiff · .452 xwOBAcon · n=34	.289 2nd SL .291	avoid **FC** .298
Behind 1-0, 2-0, 2-1, 3-1	Slider → Down & away rarely pitched there: 14 breaking all season	.272 2nd CU .284	avoid **CH** .303	Slider → Down & away his breaking there: 25% whiff · .519 xwOBAcon · n=30	.271 2nd ST .280	avoid **FS** .295
Two-strike 0-2, 1-2, 2-2, 3-2	Slider → Down & away rarely pitched there: 14 breaking all season	.293 2nd CU .298	avoid **SI** .314	Slider → Down & away his breaking there: 25% whiff · .519 xwOBAcon · n=30	.294 2nd CU .299	avoid **ST** .304

COUNTS Count tendencies — swings at 23% of first pitches (league 32%); chases 38% with two strikes (league 41%)

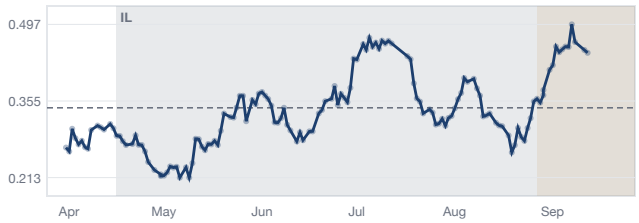
Small numbers = percentage-point difference from league in that count. Chase/whiff tinted vs league (red = better for the hitter); xwOBA on contact tinted vs league. Grey = n < 25 pitches.

BY COUNT	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Pitches	633	263	88	32	331	262	132	43	175	260	254	141
Swing %	23 -10	49 +7	41 +2	6 -1	51 +2	56 +1	68 +11	42 -9	45 -6	55 -3	66 +2	72 +2
Chase %	11 -6	25 +2	11 -9	0 -2	34 +3	36 +2	53 +20	15 -10	33 -3	34 -7	44 -1	48 +3
Whiff / swing	31 +7	28 +6	17 -3	0 -13	27 +2	29 +4	30 +9	44 +27	31 +5	30 +6	21 -0	14 -3
xwOBA on contact	.490	.517	.439	–	.399	.338	.493	.212	.318	.458	.440	.340

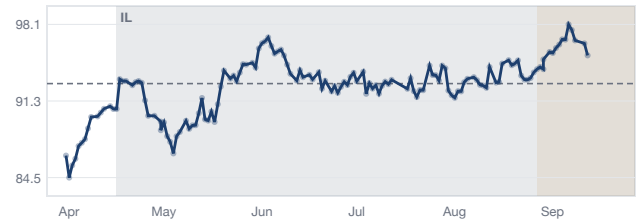
TRENDS Trends — xwOBA up lately (.444 vs .342)

15-game rolling (min 5 games); dashed = season. ⚑ = latest window differs by ≥.045 xwOBA, 2 mph EV or 5 pts chase. Grey = IL: Apr 16–season end (Core muscle injury).

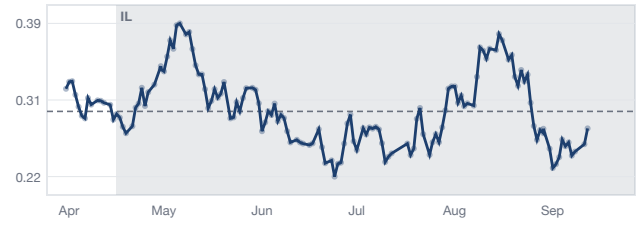
xwOBA — 15-game rolling ⚑ .444 vs .342



Avg exit velo — 15-game rolling ⚑ 95.3 mph vs 92.8 mph



Chase rate — 15-game rolling



SPLITS Platoon — 104-pt xwOBA edge vs RHP

Statcast PAs. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for the hitter). Grey: < 60 PA.

SPLIT	PA	AVG	WOBA	XWOBA	K%	BB%	HR	BARREL	CHASE
vs RHP	404	.305	.430	.379	24.3%	11.6%	29	13.8%	28%
vs LHP	220	.178	.257	.275	28.2%	6.8%	8	9.9%	33%

COMPS Comps — closest offensive profile: Corbin Carroll

Nearest qualified hitters on barrel%, EV90, contact, chase, zone swing, pull-air, GB%, launch angle, whiff by pitch group, BB% and K% (standardized, weighted).

Corbin Carroll AZ Hit 50 Pwr 60 — 70% similar
LHB · 12.1% barrel · EV90 105.8 · 75% contact · 29% chase · xwOBA .341

Joc Pederson TEX Hit 45 Pwr 60 — 63% similar
LHB · 11.3% barrel · EV90 105.5 · 72% contact · 30% chase · xwOBA .343

Ronald Acuña ATL Hit 50 Pwr 60 — 58% similar
RHB · 13.0% barrel · EV90 107.0 · 74% contact · 28% chase · xwOBA .366

Grades. z-score composites → percentile within hitters with ≥1,000 pitches seen → 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80, shown to the nearest 5. Hit = contact%, xBA, K%, whiff vs FB/BRK. Power = barrel%, EV90, max EV, ISO, hard-hit%. Discipline = chase%, zone-swing minus chase, BB%. Pull-air = pulled fly balls/liners share. Speed = FanGraphs Spd (sprint speed is not in this dataset). vs-pitch grades = hitter RV/100 by pitch group. **Models.** attack plan = situational pitch-type model scored against a league-average arsenal from each hand (this hitter's priors), then the location model's best zone for that pitch; alignment = shift-legal greedy optimizer over his balls in play with a catch-probability fielding model, gain reported 2-fold cross-validated (fit on half his BIP, scored on the other half). Predicted xwOBA gaps are small — the cited zone stats are his actual results. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; zone cells with small samples greyed; xwOBA ignores park; alignment model is approximate (no runner/game state).